



The Same Eleven Households

A Thematic Study of Canteen Rostering Across Nine Junior Sporting Clubs, and the Volunteer Levy Their Budgets Now Forecast

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Motivation

Junior sporting clubs run their canteens on rostered volunteer labour, and most attach a levy to shifts left unworked. Who ends up behind the servery, and what does the club end up counting?

Research questions

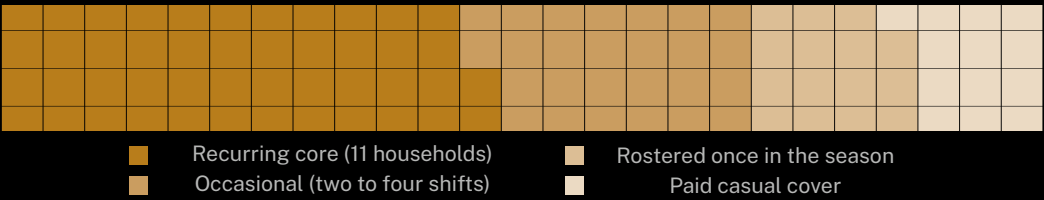
- Who works the canteen roster, and how does a shift actually get filled?
- How do club documents describe the volunteer levy, and how do officeholders describe it?
- What record, if any, does a club keep of the shifts themselves?

Study design

- 41 semi-structured interviews · 9 clubs, one metropolitan junior sporting association · parents, canteen coordinators, treasurers, coaches · one winter season
- Reflexive thematic analysis, two coders, codebook fixed before the second pass and not revised ($\kappa = 0.81$ on the final framework)
- Document analysis of all nine fee schedules, rosters and 2026 budget papers; season hours reconstructed from sign-on sheets

What we found

Canteen labour concentrates sharply, and the levy has changed hands. All nine fee schedules describe it as an encouragement to volunteer; eight of nine budgets carry it as forecast income, at between \$60 and \$220 per registered player.



Eleven households worked 46% of the 1,184 rostered canteen hours logged across the nine clubs in the 2026 winter season. No club records those hours; all nine record the levy.

Interpretation & where next

Results are consistent with a mechanism that has quietly changed function: the levy is administered by the committee that budgets for it, and the one quantity it generates measures the failure it was written to prevent.

Coordinators fill shifts by direct approach — a Thursday message to the same households — not through the roster, which survives as the document the levy is calculated against.

Next: a two-season follow-up in three clubs trialling a shift-completion record alongside the levy.

Selected references

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De-identified transcripts only; no club, ground or household is identified.

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“The levy was written to fill the roster. Eight of nine budgets now forecast it.”

No club in the study keeps a record of how many shifts went unworked.